

# NYC Stoop v3 — The Badge System

Product specification · 2026-09-27 · adapted from the "NYC Badges" concept for the NYC Stoop React/Capacitor app

## 1. Concept

Famous NYC places become collectible metal badges. A badge starts as an outline and is **struck** into metal when the user takes a photo **on the spot** — within 200 m, camera only (no photo library). Badges add up to five named levels; photos become postage-stamp keepsakes; seasonal badges add a bonus track and a secret level. Presence is the verification (the Pikmin principle): no AI photo checking, no points — only badges.

Design principles: (1) it is a self-contained **world** inside NYC Stoop with its own dark metal-and-glass identity, not a feature sprinkled across tabs; (2) the existing guide, map, planner, and feed are untouched; (3) collection is honest but low-stakes — GPS radius plus live camera, nothing more; (4) badges only, never points; progress is always stated in plain words.

## 2. Navigation — one door, one world

### 2.1 The door: Map tab medallion

A struck gold medallion (engraved BADGES, live count e.g. ★ 8/21 ★) floats bottom-right on the main Map tab, above the locate button, with a soft gold glow. It is the only badge element on the guide map. Tapping it opens the badge world full-screen.

### 2.2 Profile shelf (display, secondary door)

My Stoop shows a compact badge strip under the profile header: level name, gold progress bar, the first few medallions (struck / dashed outline / iridescent), and the next-requirement line. **A friend's profile shows their strip** — this is the social engine. Tapping the strip also opens the badge world (yours) or a read-only shelf view (a friend's).

### 2.3 Inside and out

The world carries its own top glass segmented control — **Map · Badges · Route · Photos** — over a dark map (#090D13 water, #1A1F27 land). A "< NYC Stoop" glass pill under the tabs, or a left-edge swipe (same gesture as the Posts page), exits back to wherever the user came from. The app's five bottom tabs never change.

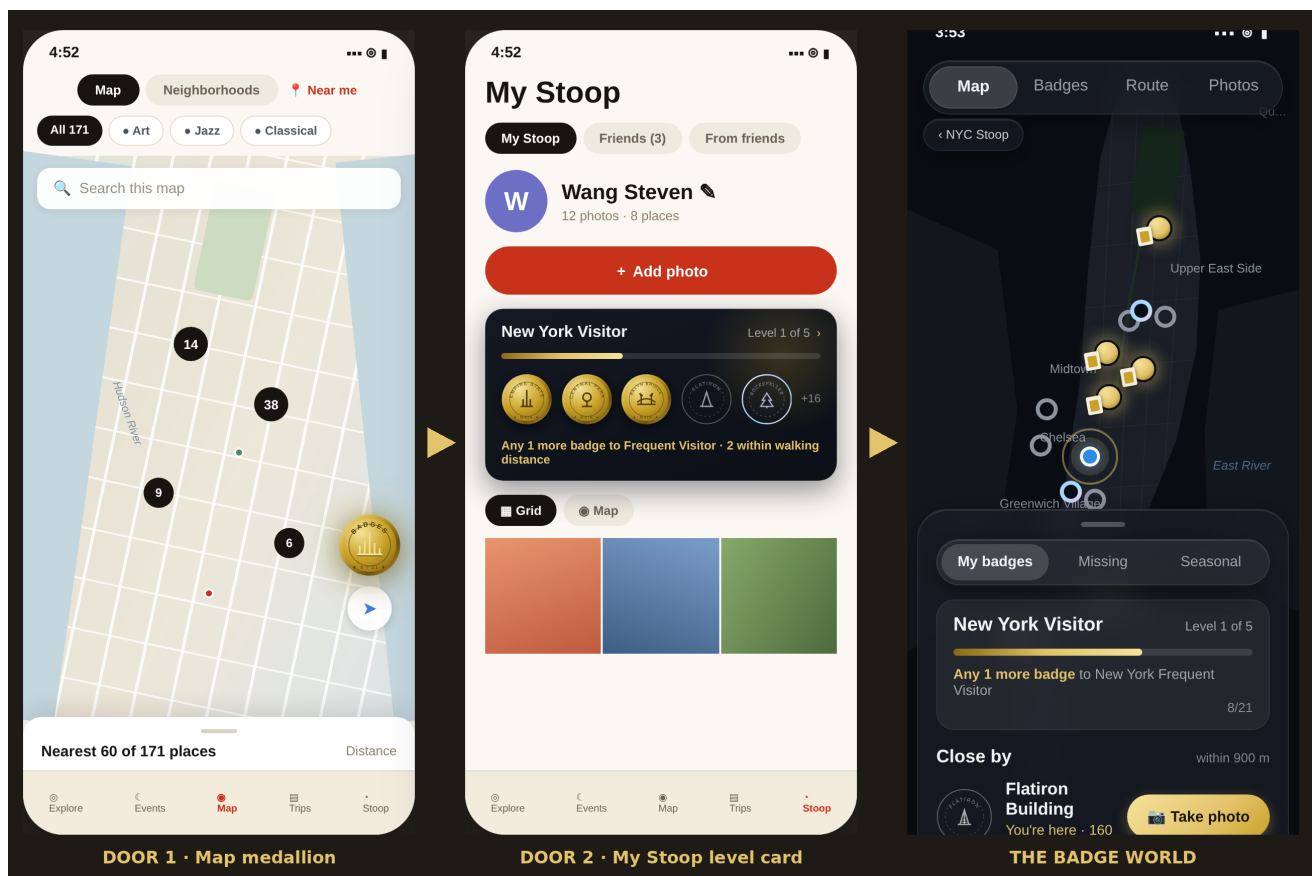


Fig. 1 — The doors and the world: Map medallion (primary), My Stoop strip (secondary), and the badge world.

## 3. The badge world, tab by tab

### 3.1 Map (default)

Dark map showing ONLY badge pins: collected = 14 pt gold coin with a tiny tilted postage stamp on its corner and a gold glow; uncollected = hollow grey ring (map shows through); seasonal = hollow iridescent ring. User location is the blue dot. Within 200 m of an uncollected badge the pin **beeps**: a scale pulse every ~1.6 s with gold ripple rings and one light haptic on entering range (foreground only — no background location). Tapping a pin opens a glass bubble (medallion, latest stamp for collected badges, share) and a name capsule; within 200 m a gold **Take photo** button appears. The bottom sheet has three detents and segments **My badges** · **Missing** · **Seasonal**: level card, Close-by list (within 900 m, nearest first, walking distances), and the collected list with dates.

### 3.2 Badges

The shelf: level card (name, Level N of 5, bar, plain-words requirement, N of 21), expandable to the level ladder with done-checks, the secret row ("???"), and Seasonal bonus x/4. Below: All · Places · Food · Stores filter and a 3-column medallion grid with status lines ("Collected" gold, season label iridescent, "Main spot", or distance).

### 3.3 Route

Hunt orderings, not day plans (Planner keeps that job). Five suggested routes ship at launch (West Side, Upper East Side, SoHo, Financial District, Midtown). Route cards: stops as overlapping mini-medallions, x/y collected. Route detail: numbered stops with walking minutes, Follow (copies into My routes), Start route (gold polyline, numbered pins, other pins dimmed to ~28%, "Next: [name]" banner). Custom routes keep nearest-first walking order. A "+ Add to Planner" bridge exports a route's stops to the NYC Stoop Planner (v3.1).

### 3.4 Photos

Badge photos only (separate lane from Stoop posts and Today photos — collecting never spams the feed). Every thumbnail is the postage-stamp rendering. Views: Places (per-badge strips) · Grid · Timeline ("Day N" with a gold rail). Viewer: stamp first, swipe to the raw photo, share from either. After striking a badge, a one-tap "Share to friends" offer can post the photo as a normal Stoop post — the user's choice, never automatic.

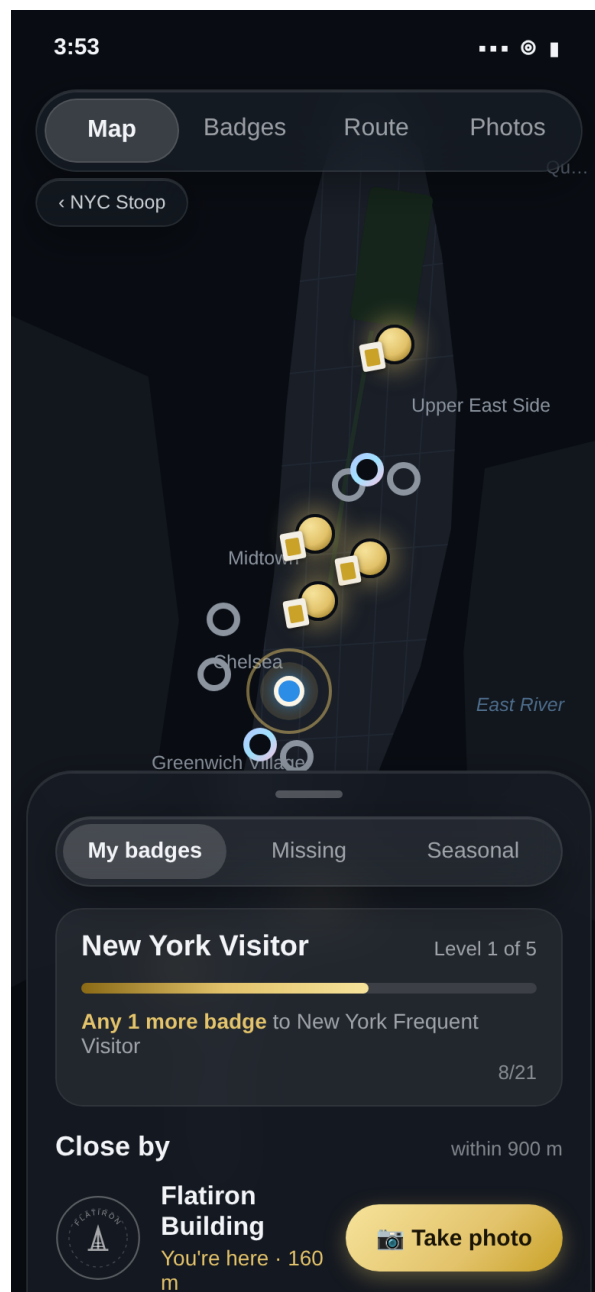


Fig. 2 — Badge world Map tab, rendered to the design system in our web stack (HTML/CSS/SVG proof).

## 4. Collecting — the rules

| Rule              | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Radius            | 200 m from the badge's coordinates, verified SERVER-side at collect time (client sends location; server computes distance).                                                                           |
| Camera only       | capture="environment" input (same as Today in NYC) — the camera opens directly; no photo library. Only a photo taken right now counts.                                                                |
| Strike            | White flash (~0.35 s), outline turns to metal with a flash-in and fast spin; light haptic.                                                                                                            |
| Visibility prompt | ~1 s after striking: "Who can see this badge?" Public (friends see it on your shelf/profile) / Private (only you; still shareable to stories). Asked every collect; changeable later in badge detail. |
| Level toast       | If the level changed: glass toast ~3 s, e.g. "Level 2 unlocked · New York Frequent Visitor".                                                                                                          |
| More photos       | Add photo on an owned badge, also 200 m gated ("On site only" otherwise).                                                                                                                             |
| Anti-cheat stance | GPS spoofing is possible and accepted at this scale; the deterrent is that cheating is pointless. Server-side radius check stops casual API abuse. No AI photo verification.                          |

## 5. Launch catalog — 25 badges

Adopted from the concept doc; coordinates verified against our places dataset before launch. Six **main spots** (brass), general places and stores (nickel), restaurants (copper), four seasonal (iridescent). Store/brand badges (Macy's, Tiffany, Strand, Katz's...) are fine in-app as place references — never merchandised.

| Badge (engraved) | Category / finish | Lat, Lng          | Notes         |
|------------------|-------------------|-------------------|---------------|
| EMPIRE STATE     | places · brass    | 40.7484, -73.9857 | Main          |
| TIMES SQUARE     | places · brass    | 40.7580, -73.9855 | Main          |
| CENTRAL PARK     | places · brass    | 40.7740, -73.9709 | Main          |
| BROOKLYN BRIDGE  | places · brass    | 40.7061, -73.9969 | Main          |
| GRAND CENTRAL    | places · brass    | 40.7527, -73.9772 | Main          |
| ONE WORLD        | places · brass    | 40.7127, -74.0134 | Main          |
| THE MET          | places · nickel   | 40.7794, -73.9632 |               |
| HIGH LINE        | places · nickel   | 40.7480, -74.0048 |               |
| FLATIRON         | places · nickel   | 40.7411, -73.9897 |               |
| WASHINGTON SQ    | places · nickel   | 40.7308, -73.9973 |               |
| CAST IRON        | places · nickel   | 40.7233, -74.0016 | SoHo district |
| CHARGING BULL    | places · nickel   | 40.7056, -74.0134 |               |
| MACY'S           | stores · nickel   | 40.7508, -73.9890 |               |
| TIFFANY & CO     | stores · nickel   | 40.7625, -73.9738 |               |
| THE STRAND       | stores · nickel   | 40.7333, -73.9907 |               |
| KATZ'S           | food · copper     | 40.7223, -73.9874 |               |
| JOE'S PIZZA      | food · copper     | 40.7305, -74.0020 |               |
| LEVAIN           | food · copper     | 40.7799, -73.9803 |               |
| CHELSEA MARKET   | food · copper     | 40.7424, -74.0061 |               |
| DOMINIQUE ANSEL  | food · copper     | 40.7253, -74.0029 |               |

| Badge (engraved) | Category / finish | Lat, Lng          | Notes          |
|------------------|-------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| STONE STREET     | food · copper     | 40.7042, -74.0105 |                |
| ROCKEFELLER TREE | seasonal · iris   | 40.7587, -73.9787 | From late Nov  |
| WINTER VILLAGE   | seasonal · iris   | 40.7536, -73.9832 | Opens late Oct |
| HALLOWEEN PARADE | seasonal · iris   | 40.7338, -73.9993 | Oct 31 only    |
| SHAKESPEARE      | seasonal · iris   | 40.7802, -73.9690 | Summer         |

Catalog growth (v3.x): outer-borough sets chosen from our 700-place dataset — scarcity stays the rule (25–30 live badges max at once).

## 6. Levels

Recommendation: keep the tourist-flavored ladder for v3.0. It works for residents too (completionism + the wink of "finally becoming a New Yorker"), and neighborhood-flavored sets can arrive additively in v3.1 without touching this ladder. Levels count badges only and stack; seasonal badges never count toward levels 1–5.

| Level  | Name                | Requirement                                        | Progress copy                                             |
|--------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| —      | Just arrived        | Start ("No level yet")                             | —                                                         |
| 1      | New York Visitor    | All 6 main spots                                   | "3 main spots left"                                       |
| 2      | NY Frequent Visitor | Mains + any 3 more                                 | "Any 1 more badge"                                        |
| 3      | New York Friend     | All 15 tourist spots (places+stores, non-seasonal) | "7 tourist spots left"                                    |
| 4      | New York Family     | All tourist spots + any 3 restaurants              | "Any 2 restaurants"                                       |
| 5      | New Yorker          | All 21 non-seasonal badges                         | "4 badges left"                                           |
| Secret | True New Yorker     | Level 5 + all 4 seasonal                           | Hidden as "???" until Level 5; then iridescent bar + hint |

Seasonal: real date windows enforced server-side; "Remind me when it opens" queues a push through the existing APNs pipeline. The "anywhere in NYC" special badges (Pizza Slice, Subway Rat...) are **deferred** — without AI checking they are honor-system, so they wait for a v3.1 decision (drop, locate them, or accept honor system).

## 7. Social layer

| Feature                                                          | v3.0                                    | Later                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Friend's shelf on their profile (level + medallions)             | Yes — respects per-badge Public/Private |                                                             |
| Push to friends on strike ("Willow collected Brooklyn Bridge")   | Yes — reuses APNs + notification bell   |                                                             |
| "At this spot": friends' public photos visible only within 200 m |                                         | v3.1 — needs server-verified location; otherwise data leaks |
| Share story/stamp images (1080×1920 render)                      |                                         | v3.1 — canvas render + system share sheet                   |

## 8. Asset spec for designers

Designers deliver **ONLY** the line-art glyph per badge; the app renders the medallion frame programmatically (rim gradient, face gradient, inner ring, serif arc name, bottom text) — one recipe guarantees consistency, and struck/outline/finish variants come free. Fig. 3 shows programmatic frames already matching the target.

| Item          | Spec                                                                                                                               |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Glyph format  | SVG, 100×100 viewBox, stroke-only paths (stroke width 5–7 units), single color, centered with ~12-unit padding; no fills, no text. |
| Per badge     | One glyph file, kebab-case id (empire.svg, katz.svg ...). 25 files at launch.                                                      |
| Engraved name | Provided as data (short name string) — the app sets it on the arc in Didot/Bodoni-style serif caps.                                |

| Item                       | Spec                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Finishes (rendered by app) | Brass #C9A227/#F6E39B/#6B5210 · Nickel #B9C0C7/#F3F7FA/#5F6A74 · Copper #B0703F/#EBB184/#5A3218 · Iris #B8C6FF/#FFFFFF/#6C78B0                |
| States (rendered by app)   | Struck (metal), Outline (thin 30% white rim, dashed inner ring, 62% glyph), Seasonal outline (iridescent rim).                                |
| Design tokens              | Bg #090D13 · Land #1A1F27 · Text #F2F4F7 · Gold #E3C36B · Pin grey #8C949F · Warning #E08A7A · Radii: sheets 34–38, cards 22, capsules round. |

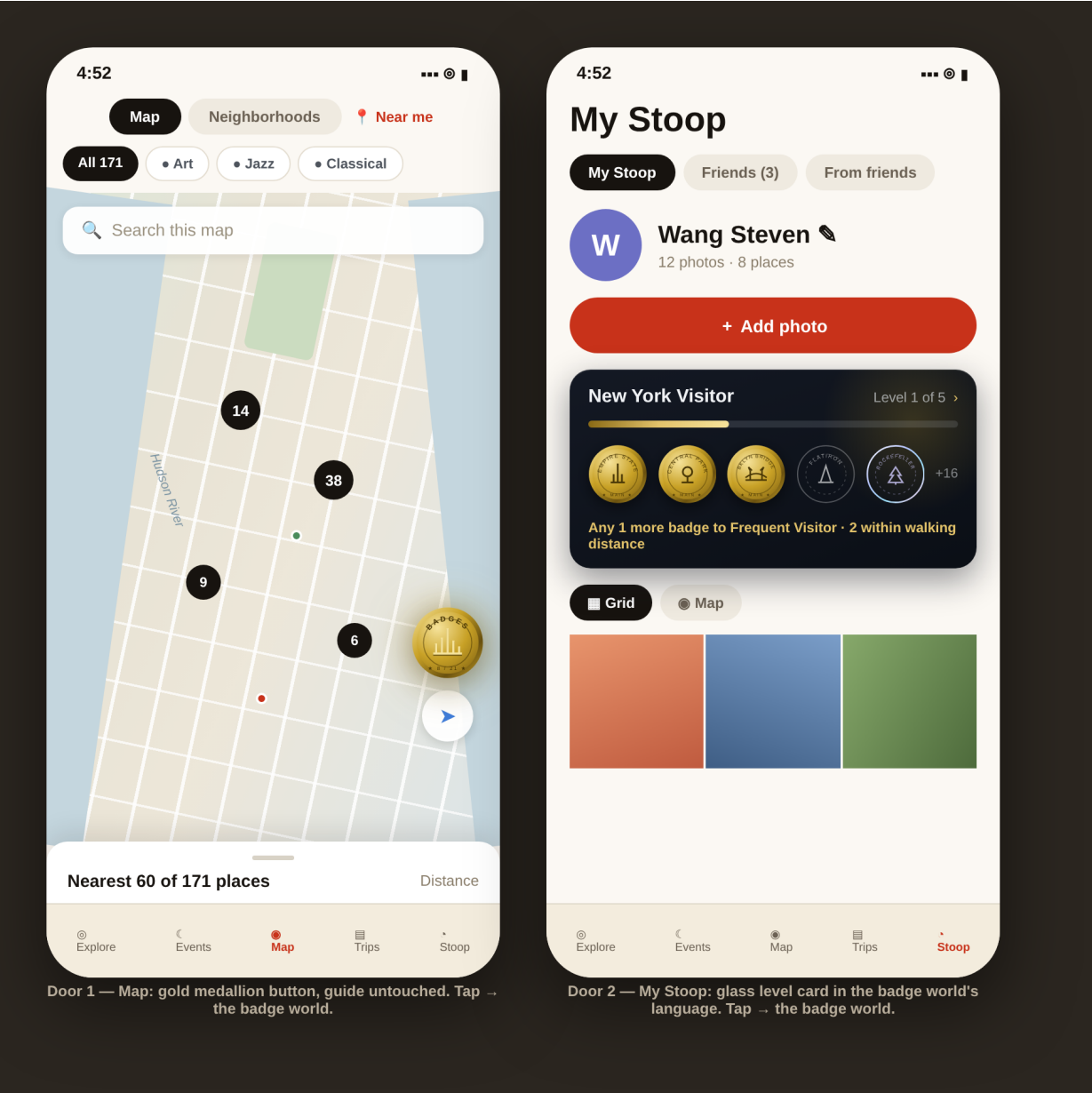


Fig. 3 — The two doors rendered with the programmatic medallion recipe (SVG rim/face/arc/glyph), proving designer glyphs are the only external asset needed.

## 9. Data model & API

| Piece                      | Shape                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| badges (static catalog)    | Ships in the client bundle + mirrored server-side: id, name, short_name, category, finish, lat, lng, is_main, season_window.                          |
| badge_awards (table)       | user_id, badge_id, first_collected_at, visibility(public private). Unique (user_id, badge_id).                                                        |
| badge_photos               | Reuses the photo pipeline: R2 keys, EXIF-stripped, linked to award; NOT in share_photos feeds.                                                        |
| POST /share/badges/collect | body: badge_id, lat, lng, image_b64, thumb_b64 → server checks radius ≤200 m + season window → creates award(+photo) → 409 if owned → pushes friends. |

| Piece                               | Shape                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| GET /share/badges/mine · /of/{user} | Awards + photo refs; /of respects visibility + friendship.                               |
| POST /share/badges/{id}/photos      | Add photo, radius-gated.                                                                 |
| PATCH /share/badges/{id}            | visibility toggle.                                                                       |
| Reminders                           | seasonal_reminders(user, badge) + a daily cron (Vercel) firing APNs when a window opens. |

## 10. Build phases

| Phase               | Contents                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Rough size           |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| A — Core loop       | World shell (door, dark theme, 4 tabs, exit) · catalog + medallion renderer · badge-world map with pins/beeping/bubble · collect flow (camera, strike, visibility, level toast) · Badges shelf + levels · profile strip · backend model + endpoints | ~2 weeks of sessions |
| B — Routes & social | Suggested + custom routes, Follow/Start, Add-to-Planner bridge · friend shelf views · strike push notifications                                                                                                                                     | ~1 week              |
| C — Keepsakes       | Photos tab (stamps, timeline, viewer) · story/stamp share renders · seasonal windows + reminders · "At this spot" (server-verified)                                                                                                                 | ~1 week              |

Ship gate: Phase A alone is a shippable v3.0 if needed; B and C can trail in 3.0.x updates.

## 11. Apple review & risk notes

No new permissions: camera and when-in-use location usage strings already shipped in 2.0; no background location in v3. Badge photos ride the approved UGC pipeline (report from viewer, owner delete, EULA unchanged). Brand-named badges are editorial references, as in the guide — no merchandise, and generic fallbacks (e.g. "HERALD SQ") stay available if we ever want distance from trademarks. The coin spin imitates a MECHANIC (Fitness awards), not Apple's artwork — fine. Main risks: scope creep (hold the Phase A line) and asset lag (25 glyphs is real design work — start it first).

## 12. Open decisions before build

1) Catalog sign-off: keep this 25 or swap picks (e.g., a Brooklyn presence beyond the bridge?). 2) Special "anywhere" badges: drop, locate, or honor-system (v3.1). 3) App-wide restyle timing relative to Phase A. 4) Who draws the 25 glyphs and by when — this is the critical path.